

The Eye of the Beholder

He lay covered by a burlap bag next to a dumpster. It was night, not too cold. All that was left today was to take note of the comings and goings of the toney jewelry store across from his alley. They were all well dressed, mostly couples. More often than not, the female would emerge from the store with a string of sparkles around her neck. They looked nice. He didn't need much, and he had most of what he needed, but he wondered how he might look in sparkles. He looked around at the garbage around him. He found an empty can and stripped off its label. It caught the light from the store window as he held it up to his chest, but no, this wouldn't do at all. Much too wide. He stood up to root through the dumpster. Anything here? Hmm.. this can isn't so big. It might work. And there's others... He found a piece of string and got busy.



They left Diamonti's still bubbling from their adventure.

"Oh, Royce! I can't believe how beautiful they are," Felicia said fingering her necklace.

"You make it so, darling... Wait! What's that in the alley?"

There in the alley, his eyes were closed. He was smiling.

"How can the city allow such people on the streets? And do you see that around his neck?"

Even from this distance it sparkled.

"A string of tiny cans, like he's a witch doctor... How can he stand to live in such filth?"

Stand it? He felt transported! What Royce and Felicia didn't understand was that in the land of the mind, the unwieldy can is bling.